

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
♥ 10 7 6 4 2
♦ A 6 4 3
♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ K

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ K, West played the ♠ 7 and North the ♠ 5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦ 10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠ 6, ♠ 5, ♠ 4, ♠ 3 and ♠ 2. So the ♠ 7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠ A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦ 10 West will win the ♦ A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠ A while you still have the ♣ A for an entry.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2



♠ J 7 5

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A 9 8

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

1 ♣

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ K

to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate South for the fine play.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ K, East played the ♠ 7 and South the ♠ 8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠ 4.

You cannot see the ♠ 5. The most likely reason is that East has it, and his ♠ 7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠ A or ♠ J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠ s to drive out South's ♠ A. When you get the lead with your ♣ A you will cash your ♠ winners and East will still have the ♦ A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if South is a better than average Declarer. East just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving South ♠ A J 8 5. South played the ♠ 8 as a falsecard

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6 3
♥ Q 10
♦ 10 9 5 4 2
♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9
♥ A 9 7 5 2
♦ A K
♣ 10 9 7



♠ 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ J 7 3
♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K J 8 3
♦ Q 8 6
♣ J 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	2 ♣	3 ♣
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♣ A			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 4

Play the ♣ 8 to encourage a continuation. East will play the ♣ Q on which you will play the ♣ 2.

East now knows you started with a doubleton, and more importantly, he also knows you want him to play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣ K dummy will ruff, but whatever card he ruffs with you will have established a trump trick. When you later win your ♠ K that will be down 1.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ J 8 4 3
♦ K J 9 5 2
♣ 8 2

♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5



♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 10 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

♠ A K 5

♥ A K Q 5

♦ A 10 6

♣ Q 10 3

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦5			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, East wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. South holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that East holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If East is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it South's chance of making 9 tricks.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

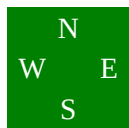
♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

2 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 2

Play the ♣ 3.

If you signal with the ♣ 9 East will continue with the ♣ K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣ J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦ K, return the ♣ 9 back to East's ♣ K, and still have your trump trick for later.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3



♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, East plays the ♠ 9, South the ♠ 5. You assume East has signaled you to continue ♠ s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick East plays the ♠ 3 and South the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both East and South are now void of ♠ s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, East won't bother ruffing, South **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠ . East will ruff and South will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of North's ♠ J. As you can see, South would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 7

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 5 2
 ♥ 8 5 3
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4



♠ K 9 6 3

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q

three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds North to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and North won the ♥A.

North now plays the ♦J on which East plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when North plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

South hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the South hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that North plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what East plays. On the ♦J East played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or

three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ Q 10 6 4
 ♦ K 7 2
 ♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4



♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥ 4			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ 4, East plays the ♥ J, won by South with ♥ A.

South plays the ♠ J, you follow with ♠ 5, dummy ♠ 3 and East plays the ♠ 2. South continues with the ♠ 10

Play the ♠ 6.

East's ♠ 2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠ s, obviously 3. Since South also must have 3, you must take your ♠ A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

South may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out South's ♥ K. You will win 2 ♥ s, 2 ♦ s and the ♠ A, down 1

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 7 3 2
 ♥ —
 ♦ 10 9 8 4 3
 ♣ A K J 9

♠ A Q 10 5
 ♥ K Q 9 4
 ♦ K J
 ♣ 8 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 4
 ♥ A 8 7 5 2
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ 6 4 2

♠ K J 6
 ♥ J 10 6 3
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ Q 10 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥5

plays his ♣2 and you win 4 tricks.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥10

Play the ♦3 (or the ♠2).

You really want East to lead a ♣ if he gets into the lead. If you discard the ♣9 East will surely get the message and will lead a ♣. BUT - you will only win 3 ♣ tricks. The ♣9 would have been the fourth winner.

So instead, play a low card in one of the other suits, say the ♦3.

North is one trick short and he sees he can easily get that trick in ♥s. So he plays a second ♥ from dummy and you now discard the ♠2. East takes the ♥A and he can see that you don't want him to lead a ♠ or a ♦. He deduces that you might like a ♣ so he

Board 10

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 4
♦ J 8 6 4 2
♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K J 7
♥ Q J 2
♦ Q 10 3
♣ K 10 7 5



♠ 8
♥ A 10 9 7 6 3
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6 2

♠ A Q 10 9 4 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A K
♣ Q 8

West	North	East	South
		2♥	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥4			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, East takes the ♥A and returns the ♥3. You ruff and then play what???

Play a low ♣.

Partner played the ♥3, a low card, for you to ruff. That means his re-entry, if he has one, is in the lower-ranking suit.

Partner takes the ♣A and gives you a second ♥ ruff.

Board 11

North Deals

None Vul

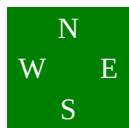
♠ 10 9 4
 ♥ 9 5 3
 ♦ Q 7 2
 ♣ A Q J 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 8 7 2

♦ J 10 5

♣ 10 5 3



♠ J 8 6 3

♥ 10 6

♦ A K 8 4

♣ 8 7 2

♠ K Q 7 5 2

♥ Q 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 9 6

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥		
All Pass			
2♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ A			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 3

Play the ♦ 2.

You know partner also has the ♦ K, and normally you would give an encouraging signal when you hold the Queen. But with this hand you want partner to switch to ♣s as soon as possible. So you play a low ♦.

East looks at your signal, then looks at dummy, then looks at your signal. He knows you want a switch and it looks like a switch to ♣s might work the best. North plays a low ♣ from dummy, you win the ♣J. Next you play a low ♦, taken by East with his ♦K. East leads a ♣. Dummy plays the ♣K, you win that, cash another ♣, then cash your ♦Q. That first signal led to your side winning the first 6 tricks. Wow.

Board 12

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 4
♥ A K 7 2
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 5

♠ A 10 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K Q J 3 2



♠ 8

♥ Q J 8 4 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ 8 7 6

♠ K Q J 7 5 2

♥ 9 5

♦ K 5

♣ A 10 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ A			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥ A, East puts on the ♥ Q. It's your play.

Play the ♥ 2.

East's ♥ Q is either a singleton, (practically impossible), or a signal showing that he also holds the ♥ J. In either case you can reach the East hand on the second trick by playing a low ♥. Since you don't particularly want to start playing ♦ s from your side, you go ahead and play a small ♥, won by East with the ♥ J.

East next plays the ♦ Q and however South tries it your side will take the next two ♦ tricks and set the contract.

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 9 6 3 2

♥ K 2

♦ Q J 8

♣ 8 7 6

♠ A Q

♥ J 10 4

♦ 10 7 4 3

♣ A K J 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 7 4

♥ 6 3

♦ A K 9 6

♣ 9 5 3

♠ J 5

♥ A Q 9 8 7 5

♦ 5 2

♣ Q 10 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦ A

before North can pull trumps and discard one of dummy's ♠s on his fourth ♣.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. East led the ♦ A, dummy played the ♦ 2

Play the ♦ Q.

As soon as dummy appears you can see 3 tricks for your side. Partner surely has the ♦ K to go with his Ace and you have a certain trump trick. However, that's all you can see.

Your best hope is that East may be able to win a ♠ trick, and it may be important for the first ♠ lead to come from your side of the table.

Your ♦ Q play informs partner that you also have the ♦ J, giving him the option of underleading his ♦ K to get to your hand.

East next plays a small ♦ which you win with your ♦ J. You return the ♠ 10. This establishes East's ♠ K

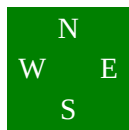
Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 5 2
 ♥ A Q 10 6
 ♦ 9 5 4 2
 ♣ —

♠ 7
 ♥ 5 3 2
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A K J 9 6 4 2
 ♠ 10 8 4
 ♥ J 7 4
 ♦ K Q 8 6
 ♣ Q 7 3
 ♠ A K Q 3
 ♥ K 9 8
 ♦ A J 10
 ♣ 10 8 5



<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	3NT		1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 5

♥ J. Hopefully.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ 5, East plays the ♠ 10 and South wins the ♠ K. To the second trick South plays the ♣ 10 and you must discard something.

Play the ♠ J.

You know that East has no high ♠ honor or he would have played it to the first trick. So South has the ♠ A Q left, plus all those ♣ tricks. You need to have West switch to a ♥ if possible.

East must be expecting to lead a ♠ back when he wins the ♣ Q which you hope he holds. Your ♠ J discard may make him rethink. If your ♠ s were any good why would you be discarding a winner when all you had to do was toss a small red card?

Hopefully East will come to the conclusion that this is Suit Preference for a ♥ return and will play his

Board 15

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ 9
♦ J 8 7 2
♣ A 9 8 6 5 3

♠ J 8 5

♥ A Q J 8 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K



♠ A K Q 7 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 6 5 3

♣ 10 7 2

♠ 9 6 2

♥ K 10 6 3

♦ Q 9 4

♣ Q J 4

West	North	East	South
	1♥	1♠	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♠A			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠A, dummy played the ♠2 and you signal with your ♠10. East next plays the ♠Q and you drop the ♠4, completing your doubleton signal. East then plays the ♠K and it turns out you don't have to ruff after all. So what are you going to play?

Play the ♣9.

This should be a clear enough signal for East to play a ♣ to your ♣A next.

An alternate play, just as good, would be for you to ruff the good ♠Q and play the ♣A yourself.

If you don't get your ♣ trick at trick 4 you will never get it. North will discard his ♣K on South's extra ♦ winner.

Board 16

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10
 ♥ 9 6 4 3
 ♦ 9 7 5
 ♣ K Q 10 6 3

♠ Q J 9 8 6 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ Q 8 4

♣ J



♠ 2
 ♥ A K J
 ♦ J 10 6 3 2
 ♣ A 9 7 2

♠ A K 7 5 4

♥ 10 8 5

♦ A K

♣ 8 5 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♣K

tricks. Had he switched to a ♦ instead, South would have been able to discard one of his ♥ losers on North's ♦Q.

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, dummy's singleton was played

Play the ♣9.

West will look at your ♣9 and perhaps think for an instant that you want him to play another ♣.

But it will be a short instant because a look at dummy makes it absolutely clear to everybody that playing another ♣ could not help your side. Dummy has so many trumps that repeated ♣ leads would do nothing.

OK. If it's not an encouraging Attitude signal, what is it? Suit preference of course. Since it is a high spot card you are asking West to switch to the higher suit (choosing between ♦s and ♥s).

West dutifully plays a ♥ and you take the next three

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ J 10 6 2
♦ K J 9 5 4 2
♣ 3

♠ K Q J 9 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 6

♣ 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5

♥ 9 7 3

♦ A 8 7

♣ A K 9 8 6 4

♠ A 10 6

♥ A K Q 4

♦ Q 10 3

♣ Q J 2

West

North

East

South

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♣A

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A. Seeing your ♣3 he next played the ♦A. What will you play on this trick?

Play the ♦2.

Normally with this holding you would play the ♦9 to encourage East to play a second ♦ through dummy's ♦Q 10.

But this time you really want him to take his ♣K. So play the discouraging ♦2 and hope he gets the message to go back to ♣s. If he does play the ♣K next it will win and he can then give you a ♣ ruff.

Board 18

South Deals

None Vul

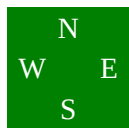
♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ K Q 8 5 3
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 4

♠ 6 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ K 7 3



♠ J 10 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ A 9 5

♠ A K Q

♥ A 10

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥5			

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥5, you put on the ♥J, South won with the ♥A. The second trick was ♦A, ♦2, ♦3, ♦5. The third trick was ♦J, ♦6, ♦8, ♦7. South then put the ♣Q on the table.

Play the ♣A.

Does it look to you like South is trying to create an entry to dummy so he can cash the 2 ♦ winners? That's what he wants it to look like, hoping someone holds up their ♣A.

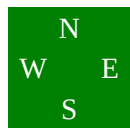
But don't believe Declarer, believe your partner. On the first ♦ West played the ♦2. On the second ♦ he played the ♦6. He has an odd number of ♦s, obviously 3. And South must also have a third one, so he is up to some trickery with that ♣Q.

So grab your ♣A and return partner's ♥ suit.

Board 19
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 8 4

♠ A Q J 2
♥ J 10 3
♦ A K 10
♣ J 10 3



♠ 7 5
♥ 9 7 4 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4
♥ A 6
♦ Q J 3
♣ A K 9

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			
Lead: ♠5			

then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to East's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. North liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by North's ♠Q. North pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and East plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick North drops the ♥J and East the ♥2. It is your play.

Play the ♥K.

If you believe North is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe North when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that North has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but

Board 20

West Deals

None Vul

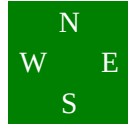
♠ A Q 10
 ♥ 9 2
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ A K 10 6 3

♠ 6 4

♥ A J 8

♦ A Q J 6

♣ 8 7 5 4



♠ 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ Q 2

♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 7 6 4 3

♦ K 10

♣ J 9

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♣ A			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣ A, East played the ♣ 2 and South the ♣ 9. What should you play to the second trick?

Play the ♣ 6.

On first thought East's ♣ 2 seems to be a discouraging signal. Think again.

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣ Q and ♣ J. If East started with ♣ J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣ J. If East started with ♣ Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣ Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣ 2 or with ♣ Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣ Q or he will ruff.

It turns out that he wins with the ♣ Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.